

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: East

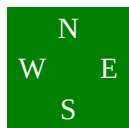
Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4 3
♥ Q 10 4
♦ 8 7 3
♣ J 8 7 4

♠ A 6
♥ A K 9 6 5
♦ J 10 5
♣ Q 10 2



♠ K Q J 9 5
♥ -
♦ 9 6 4 2
♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 10 7 2
♥ J 8 7 3 2
♦ A K Q
♣ A K

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	3♦
Pass	3NT	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North
the ♠ winner East has you will defeat the slam.

If you cover the ♥J with your ♥Q North will again win with one of his high ones. But now the position will be clear to North and he will return to dummy and play another ♥, finessing your ♥10. With no trump loser he will make the slam.

[showcards N:HJ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

East led the ♠K, won by North's ♠A. North played a small ♣ to dummy's ♣A, then led dummy's ♥J.

What do you play? ♥Q or ♥4?

Play the ♥4.

Remember that North opened 1♥, so he has 5 of them. With only 3 trumps out he has no intention of finessing. Perhaps he led the ♥J just to tempt you to cover in this situation.

If you play low he will win with one of his high ♥s and then you will have a sure ♥ winner. Along with

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

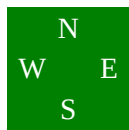
♠ Q J 6
 ♥ 10 5 4
 ♦ A K 3
 ♣ A Q 7 4

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ A 3

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ K J 9



♠ 8 3
 ♥ K Q J 9 8 6
 ♦ Q 7 5
 ♣ 6 2

♠ A 9 5 2

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4

♣ 10 8 5 3

West

North

East

South

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

That winner will take care of whatever black-suit loser he may have.

If North has a ♣ trick it is important to get it established soon. So go up with the ♠A and play a ♣ through dummy's ♣ A Q. When East tries the ♠ suit again **NORTH** can win and cash his ♣K for the setting trick.

If you play low on East's ♠ play North will be forced to win the trick and he cannot profitably attack the ♣ suit from his side.

[showcards W:H2 E:HA,H3,DJ S:S3,HK,H6,D6]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

You decide a trump lead is called for and lead the ♥2. Your partner wins with the ♥A and plays the ♦J. East lets this go to dummy's ♦K, (but you know he has ♦Q), then plays a trump back to his ♥K, pulling the 2 outstanding trumps from South and North.

East's next play is the ♠3 from his hand. Do you play your ♠A or not?

Play the ♠A.

Even if East doesn't have the ♠K he can establish a ♠ winner just by leading twice toward the ♠ Q J.